

Evaluating DRM Policy Frameworks: A Rapid Screening Tool

Evaluate a country's policy and institutional setting for Disaster Risk Management across six critical pillars

Prototype: this will be updated following test cases. Your feedback is welcomed.

This web tool allows practitioners to conduct an assessment of a country's Disaster Risk Management (DRM) policy framework.

Recognizing that a comprehensive policy diagnostic requires a system-wide perspective, the tool is organized around the World Bank's DRM framework, which outlines six key DRM policy dimensions. The reader is referred to the accompanying [Methodological Note](#) for a thorough description of the DRM framework and this tool.

The DRM policy framework: pillars and thematic areas

Legal and Institutional DRM Framework (Transversal)	
Comprehensive policy reforms that establish or strengthen the legal and institutional foundations of DRM at national and subnational levels and across sectors. Thematic Areas: <i>DRM Policies and Institutions Mainstreaming DRM into National Development Plans.</i>	
Risk Identification	Tools and processes to understand disaster risks, which are essential for guiding risk reduction and enabling data-informed policy reforms.
Risk Reduction	Proactive policy reforms to reduce existing hazard risks, prevent new ones, and enhance disaster resilience. Thematic Areas: <i>Territorial and Urban Planning Public Investment Management Sector-Specific Risk Reduction Measures.</i>
Preparedness	Preparedness efforts to ensure that communities and governments are ready to act when a disaster occurs. Thematic Areas: <i>Early Warning Systems Emergency Preparedness and Response Adaptive Social Protection.</i>
Financial Protection	Strategies and instruments designed to reduce the financial impact of disasters on governments, businesses, and households. Thematic Areas: <i>Fiscal Risk Disaster Risk Financing Strategies and Instruments.</i>
Resilient Reconstruction	Integration of resilience into recovery plans; prioritizing investments that reduce vulnerability.

This is a high-level assessment designed to be objective and quick. Each DRM thematic area is evaluated using a set of closed Yes/No questions contained in an offline [Questionnaire](#). Within each thematic area, questions follow the results chain logic used in Development Policy Financing (DPF) operations, progressing from policy and institutional inputs, through reform implementation, to outputs and outcomes that contribute to strengthened disaster resilience. Users should review official documentation (legal, regulatory, institutional, and budgetary) and report sources in the “Sources” column, including where possible, electronic links to supporting documents to enhance transparency and robustness. While some questions can be addressed through desk review, others may require consultations with colleagues and national authorities. This is particularly relevant for cross-cutting questions, where inputs from colleagues from sectors such as Water, Transport, Education, Health, and Agriculture may help in gathering information.

This tool is intended to support in-country DRM policy dialogue, operational engagements, and technical assistance design. It provides a diagnostic of the DRM framework that should be viewed as an entry point for structured policy dialogue rather than a definitive or exhaustive assessment. In practice, the insights that users will gain by completing the questionnaire are as important as the final results. Users are therefore encouraged to record qualitative observations in the “Notes/Comments” column. This space may be used to clarify responses (for example, to note weaknesses despite a “Yes” response, or strengths despite a “No” response), or to flag a potential policy reform identified during the diagnostic. If users are uncertain about a response, they may select a “Partially” or “Unknown” option and provide additional context in the comments, including which national counterparts or colleagues could help clarify the issue. This information can facilitate the identification of key stakeholders to be engaged during initial phases of the policy dialogue.

Once all questions are completed, the web tool will automatically generate key metrics and visual outputs across each DRM thematic area. Together these outputs help identify relative strengths and weaknesses within the DRM system and support the prioritization of reforms that may be considered under DPF operations.

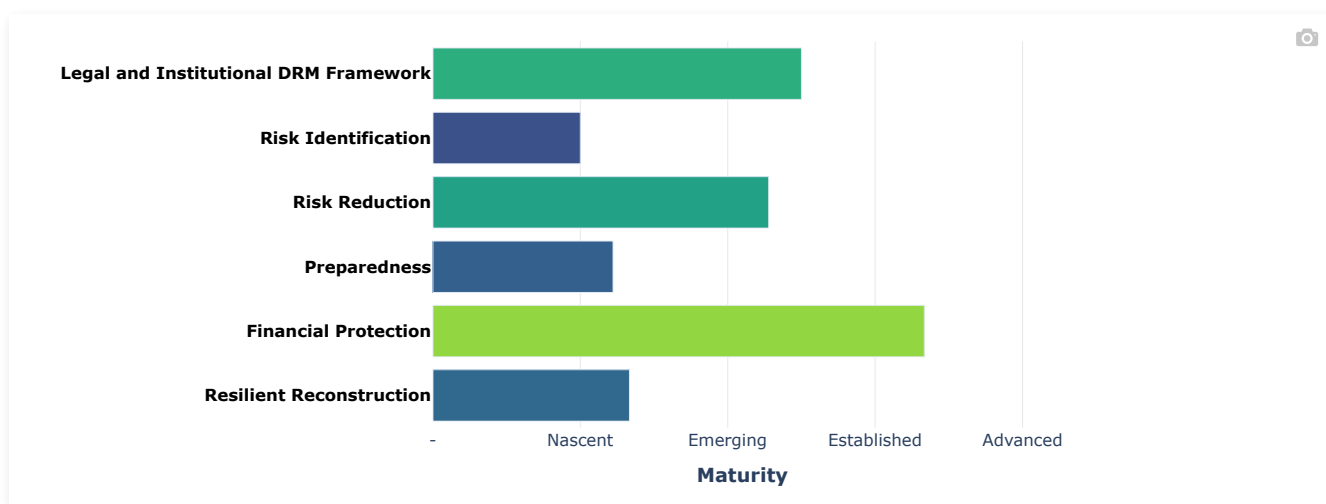
Assessment Results

The petal diagram summarizes the assessment results. Each petal represents a thematic area of the DRM framework. Below the diagram, results are aggregated by DRM pillar to highlight key drivers and gaps.

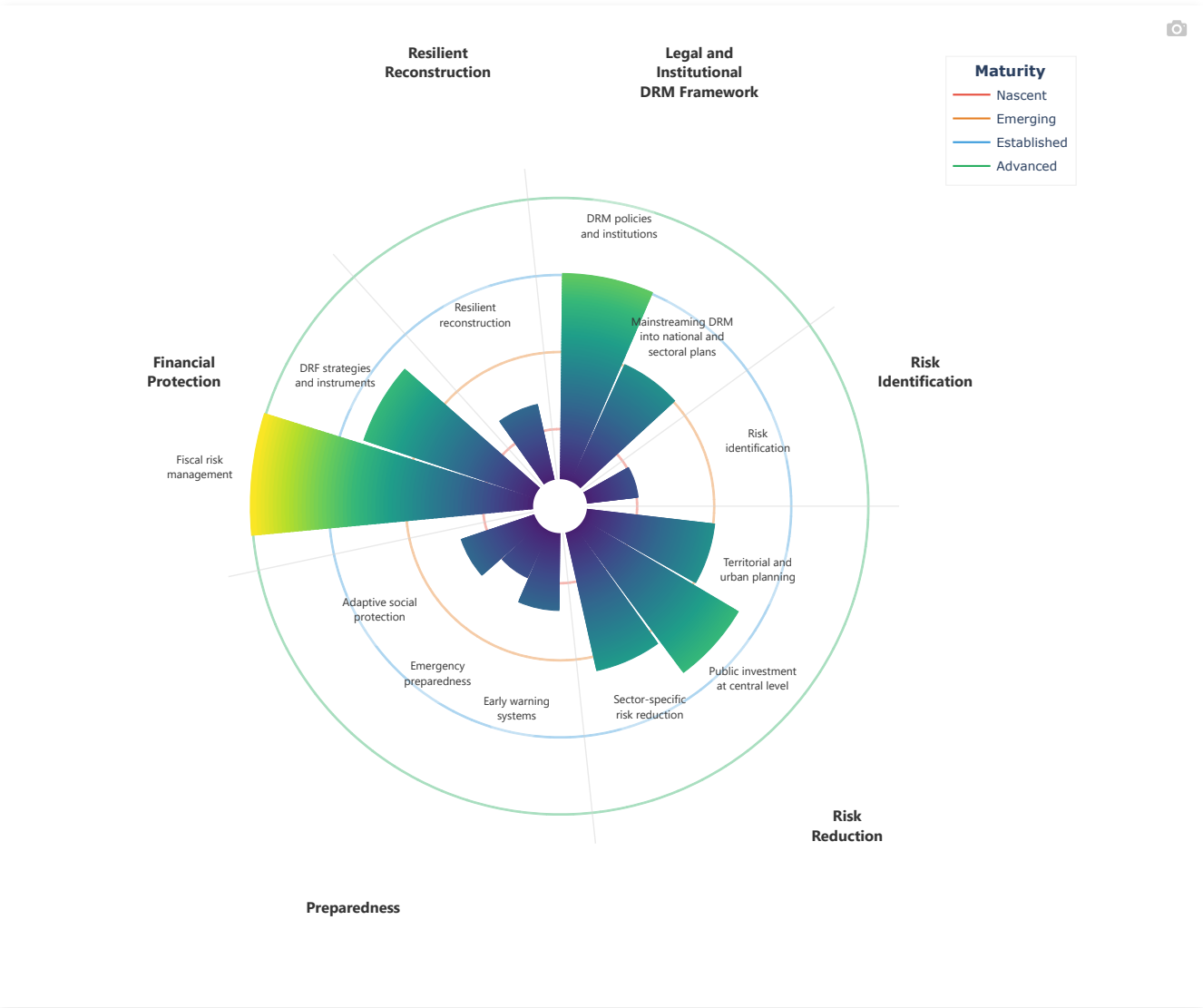
- **Petal length** reflects progress in that thematic area: the longer the size of the petal, the more advanced the country is. Conversely, shorter petals indicate areas where the policy framework is weak and/or not producing the expected outcomes.
- **When a petal extends beyond the red circle**, minimum policy requirements for that area are considered in place.
- **Countries with mature DRM systems** typically have most petals exceeding the red circle, with some approaching the frontier (i.e., indicating progress close to the global benchmark frontier). Importantly, a thematic area rated as mature by this tool does not necessarily imply that there is no scope for further policy action to improve the practical functioning of the area.

While the evaluation reflects lessons learned and good practices that can serve as a foundation for a robust DRM policy framework, it should not be interpreted as prescriptive guidance. Disaster risk is highly context-specific, and this diagnostic represents only an initial step toward developing an appropriate and effective DRM policy program. Users are encouraged to consult the report [Driving Resilience Through Policy Reforms](#) for further guidance on how to structure a context-relevant DRM policy program.

Results by DRM Pillar



Results by Thematic Area



✓ All thematic areas meet or exceed the minimum standard.

Detailed Results by Thematic Area

This text was generated automatically by a Large Language Model (LLM). Users should verify the content and cross-reference with official documentation. For the purpose of generating these text summaries, 'Partially' and 'Unknown' answers are treated the same as 'No'.

Legal and Institutional DRM Framework

DRM policies and institutions Established

There is a strong policy architecture in place within Cabo Verde, with a clear legal framework, supporting regulations, and recent strategic updates. The system is conceptually sound; however, the lack of dedicated funding remains a significant bottleneck that likely prevents these strategies from being fully executed.

Mainstreaming DRM into national and sectoral development plans Emerging

⚠️ **High number of 'Unknown' answers (1/2). Follow-up recommended.**

Cabo Verde has successfully integrated DRM into its high-level National Development Strategy, signaling strong political will at the top. However, this vision has not yet trickled down to the sectoral level. Without explicit targets in ministries like Health, Education, or Transport, the national strategy remains a high-level commitment that lacks the departmental execution needed for local impact.

Risk Identification

Risk identification Nascent

⚠️ **High number of 'Unknown' answers (3/4). Follow-up recommended.**

Cabo Verde has established the legal groundwork by defining who is responsible for managing risk information. However, this data remains siloed, inaccessible to the public, and disconnected from other government entities. Without formal exchange mechanisms or climate integration, the legal mandate hasn't yet translated into actionable intelligence.

Risk Reduction

Territorial and urban planning Emerging

⚠️ **High number of 'Unknown' answers (2/4). Follow-up recommended.**

In Cabo Verde, laws mandate risk-informed planning and procedures exist for high-risk settlements. However, the lack of standardized methodologies and consistent recent application suggests that urban planning decisions may be made on a case-by-case basis rather than through a uniform national system.

Public investment at the central level Emerging

The framework in Cabo Verde is technically sound, with both a legal mandate and official screening methodologies in place. However, the system fails at the finish line: even when projects are identified as high-risk, there is no formal requirement to actually implement risk mitigation measures before approval.

Sector-specific risk reduction measures Emerging

⚠️ **High number of 'Unknown' answers (5/9). Follow-up recommended.**

Cabo Verde has prioritized resilient standards for the transport sector. While roads are being built to survive disasters, the lack of similar standards for schools, hospitals, and energy grids suggests an imbalanced approach to national resilience. In Cabo Verde, new buildings are protected by codes and water management is coordinated under a legal flood-risk framework. However, the country has not funded the retrofitting of old buildings or seen recent improvements in its watershed basins.

Preparedness

Early warning systems Nascent

In Cabo Verde, the population received prompt alerts during the last major disaster, which is a significant operational success. However, the lack of formal inter-institutional coordination and the absence of a dedicated budget for monitoring equipment suggest that the system is currently relying on ad-hoc efforts rather than a sustainable national framework.

Emergency preparedness and response Nascent

Cabo Verde has established a legal framework for EP&R, defining institutional roles on paper. However, without a national contingency plan or local protocols to operationalize these roles, the system lacks the practical roadmap needed to coordinate an effective response when a disaster strikes.

Adaptive social protection Nascent

⚠️ **High number of 'Unknown' answers (2/3). Follow-up recommended.**

Cabo Verde has established a legal framework for ASP, defining how social protection and DRM agencies should work together. However, without a unified social registry or a track record of prompt delivery, the system remains a theoretical concept that has not yet been translated into an operational tool for shock response.

Financial Protection

Fiscal risk management Advanced

Cabo Verde represents a benchmark for fiscal resilience. With a dedicated risk unit, rigorous quantification of liabilities, transparent reporting in fiscal frameworks, and climate-disaster debt stress testing, the government has a comprehensive grip on its potential financial exposure.

DRF strategies and instruments Emerging

Cabo Verde has sovereign financing instruments in place and has successfully increased its available funding recently. While the financial volume is growing, the lack of clear insurance regulations for public and private assets may lead to inconsistent coverage or gaps in protection for specific sectors.

Resilient Reconstruction

Resilient reconstruction Nascent

In Cabo Verde, territorial planning instruments have been updated to reduce risk following a major disaster, which shows a strong reactive will to improve. However, this progress is hindered by the lack of a legal framework for recovery coordination and a lack of standardized methodologies for damage assessment.